

Alina Evidence-First Research Report Draft

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1. Executive Summary

Alina is a proposed daily companion app combining personal meaning, identity reinforcement, coaching/action, short reset practices, and game-like progression. The research now supports a more precise opportunity statement: adjacent markets and partial substitutes are real, but the under-owned space appears to be the causal loop where completing a daily action visibly changes an identity/avatar feedback object.

Current evidence verdict: **continue research / conditional go**. The market existence signal is strong enough to keep going; the remaining proof burden is competitor manual review, detailed pricing/paywall extraction, forum evidence beyond App Store reviews, and user validation of the avatar-progress mechanic.

Key quantified signals:

- Expanded competitor universe: 12552 deduplicated rows from 4 source kinds.
- Audience signal rows: 20492.
- High whitespace candidates: 593; medium: 4040; low: 7919.
- Top-100 intersection candidates enriched from App Store metadata: 100/100.
- AI-assisted top-100 competitor review: 100 rows, 90 unique primary apps, 45 high-threat apps, 1 direct reference competitor.
- App Store IAP pricing layer: 498 observed purchase rows across 80 apps; observed price range \$0.00-\$549.99.
- Strict behavior-tied avatar progression signal in top-100: 1/100.
- App Store review-language layer: 2294 reviews from 78 top-candidate apps, mapped into 2288 signal rows.
- Review JTBD/pain clusters: 12 themes; top cluster is "Users want more depth, options, or customization" with 612 rows.
- Forum/source evidence map: 18 qualitative rows across 5 market pillars.
- Forum quote coding layer: 72 snippet rows across 18 sources.
- Draft visual chart pack: whitespace bands, review clusters, SAM by pillar, SOM scenarios, forum source coverage, top-100 competitor verdicts, IAP price bands, and forum quote coding.
- Modeled direct intersection SAM base: USD 201960000.

2. Product Hypotheses

ID	Hypothesis	Status	Evidence
H1	Product shape exists	partially supported	Adjacent apps combine several pillars; top-100 shows meaning/action/reset/progress language.
H2	Markets have money	supported with ranges	TAM/SAM/SOM model and 14 market claims across gaming, astrology, avatar, coaching, mindfulness.
H3	Whitespace exists	narrowed	Broad space is crowded; strict behavior-tied avatar progression appears rare in top-100 metadata.
H4	Competitive advantage is plausible	unproven but sharpened	Moat candidate is integrated daily transformation loop, not any single feature.

ID	Hypothesis	Status	Evidence
H5	Shared audience exists	directionally supported	Audience matrix plus 2288 review-language signals point to digital ritual users across spirituality, identity, self-improvement, calm, and cozy progress.
H6	Product core can be defined	supported for MVP framing	Product-core evidence defines target loop and MVP testable claim.

3. Dataset Overview

Expanded Rows by Niche

- gaming: 3137
- coaching: 2534
- mindfulness: 2399
- avatar_identity: 2281
- astrology_esoterics: 2201

Expanded Rows by Source Kind

- app_store_search: 8103
- steam_search: 2585
- google_play_search_fallback: 1808
- duckduckgo_search: 56

4. Market Sizing

The model intentionally avoids adding five TAMs together. Gaming is treated primarily as a mechanic benchmark; direct SAM is modeled from discounted adjacent consumer app markets.

Pillar	TAM Low	TAM Base	TAM High	SAM Low	SAM Base	SAM High	Confidence
gaming	113000000000	134220000000	166000000000	226000000	671100000	1660000000	medium
astrology_esoterics	5690000000	6240000000	16070000000	170700000	374400000	1607000000	low_medium
avatar_identity	1920000000	8400000000	14130000000	38400000	420000000	1130400000	medium
coaching	4220000000	5000000000	6690000000	126600000	300000000	669000000	medium
mindfulness	1680000000	1680000000	4620000000	134400000	252000000	1155000000	medium
intersection	470100000	1346400000	4561400000	37608000	201960000	1140350000	low

SOM Sensitivity

Scenario	Reachable Users	Activation	Paid Conversion	ARPPU/year	Annual Revenue
conservative_12m	100000	0.35	0.03	60	63000
base_24m	1000000	0.4	0.05	80	1600000
upside_36m	5000000	0.45	0.08	100	18000000
breakout_36m	10000000	0.5	0.1	120	60000000

5. Competitive Landscape

Top-100 Archetype Mix

- manifestation_tool: 30
- avatar_identity_coaching: 23
- gamified_self_improvement: 16
- astrology_guidance: 12
- tarot_or_oracle_guidance: 9
- faith_devotional_habit: 8
- ai_companion_roleplay: 2

Pricing Signals

- free_entry: 28
- credits_or_consumables: 21
- subscription: 8
- premium: 7
- enterprise_or_human_service: 2
- trial: 2

Observed App Store IAP Pricing

Public App Store pages exposed 498 in-app purchase rows across 80 top-candidate apps. This is observed webpage pricing, not guaranteed complete backend IAP catalog data.

Observed price bands:

- 15_to_49_99: 191
- 5_to_14_99: 132
- 50_to_99_99: 81
- under_5: 74
- 100_plus: 20

Observed IAP product tags:

- subscription_like: 287
- unclear_iap: 161
- consumable_or_unlock: 34
- lifetime_like: 27
- trial_like: 10

Highest observed IAP ceilings:

App	IAP Rows	Min	Max	Product Tags
Awaken: AI Coach & Inner Guide	9	4.99	549.99	unclear_iap:7/subscription_like:2
Ask Nithyananda AI	3	54.00	509.00	unclear_iap:3
Motivate: Daily Motivation	4	11.99	399.99	subscription_like:4/lifetime_like:1
Mindvalley: Self Improvement	8	19.99	399.00	unclear_iap:7/subscription_like:1
Mia Adora	10	1.00	334.99	unclear_iap:6/consumable_or_unlock:3/subscription_like:1
Eylo: AI Weight Loss Coach	5	4.99	179.99	unclear_iap:3/subscription_like:2
MindFi: Mind Fitness for All	3	5.99	174.99	subscription_like:2/lifetime_like:1
Yoga International	2	19.99	169.00	subscription_like:2

Retention Signals

- streaks: 92
- reminders_habits: 92
- journaling_reflection: 72
- social: 69
- xp_levels: 60
- daily_loop: 57
- avatar_feedback: 54
- quests_challenges: 30

AI-Assisted Top-100 Competitor Review

The top-100 candidate set now has an AI-assisted scorecard that combines App Store metadata, product-core scoring, pricing/retention tags, review-language signals, and JTBD/pain clusters. This is a strong triage layer but still needs human product validation before final claims.

Coverage: 100 rows, 90 unique primary apps, 10 duplicate app entries, 75 unique apps with public review signals.

Competitor verdict counts:

- high_priority_close_substitute: 48
- close_substitute: 30
- monetization_risk_benchmark: 12
- adjacent_benchmark: 9
- direct_reference_competitor: 1

Highest-threat primary competitors:

Rank	App	Threat	Verdict	Core	Behavior Progression
1	Shepherd: Spiritual Bible BFF	40.9	direct_reference_competitor	6	yes

Rank	App	Threat	Verdict	Core	Behavior Progression
80	Zing AI: Home & Gym Workouts	34	high_priority_close_substitute	5	no
73	Miracle Morning Routine	33.7	high_priority_close_substitute	5	no
100	Daily Yoga: Yoga for Fitness®	31.6	high_priority_close_substitute	5	no
31	Vida Health	31	high_priority_close_substitute	5	no
49	Daily Burn: Workout Coach	31	high_priority_close_substitute	5	no
63	EVOLVE: Transform Your Life	31	high_priority_close_substitute	5	no
84	Motivate: Daily Motivation	30.9	high_priority_close_substitute	5	no
53	Yoga International	30.8	high_priority_close_substitute	5	no
55	Unplug: Meditation	30.8	high_priority_close_substitute	5	no

Competitive interpretation: the field is full of close substitutes, but only one direct reference competitor currently shows strict behavior-tied avatar/identity progression. That keeps the whitespace narrow but real.

6. Whitespace Analysis

Broad whitespace is weak: the market already has many products that combine meaning, habits, AI, mindfulness, and identity language. Narrow whitespace is stronger: top-100 metadata shows only one strict signal of behavior-tied avatar progression.

Product Core Signals in Top-100

Core Element	Detected	Out Of
Personal meaning	100	100
One daily action	96	100
Short reset	80	100
Avatar or identity	100	100
Behavior-tied progression	1	100
Next-day hook	94	100

7. Audience Segmentation

The strongest shared-audience hypothesis is not "people who use all five app categories." It is people who already use digital rituals to regulate identity and emotion.

Audience signal counts:

- gen_z_creator_identity: 5754
- casual_gamers: 4098

- self_improvement_users: 4067
- anxious_stressed_users: 3072
- spiritual_seekers: 2569
- coaching_professionals: 932

App Store Review Language

Recent public App Store reviews were collected for top intersection candidates. Coverage is 2294 deduplicated reviews across 78 apps, converted into keyword-based signal rows. This is not final sentiment modeling, but it is useful evidence for user language, delight, objections, and churn risk.

Review rating mix:

- 5: 1473
- 1: 415
- 4: 160
- 3: 137
- 2: 109

Review signal counts:

- content_depth_request: 605
- pricing_complaint: 367
- loves_daily_loop: 347
- loves_avatar_progress: 300
- loves_emotional_support: 238
- quality_bug_complaint: 150
- churn_signal: 139
- trust_accuracy_complaint: 62
- privacy_safety_signal: 40
- loves_personalization: 40

Interpretation: users respond strongly to daily ritual loops, emotional support, and visible progress/identity mechanics; recurring objections cluster around content depth, subscription value, bugs, trust/accuracy, and safety/privacy.

JTBD and Pain Clusters from Reviews

Cluster	Type	Rows	Apps	Avg Rating	Product Implication
Users want more depth, options, or customization	pain	612	69	3.72	Depth should be earned after the core loop, especially custom rituals, richer avatar choices, and accessibility options.
Give me a daily anchor I can return to	jtbtd	415	58	4.21	Alina needs one obvious recurring ritual, not a menu of disconnected features.

Cluster	Type	Rows	Apps	Avg Rating	Product Implication
Turn vague self-improvement into concrete actions	jtbd	371	54	4.24	The product should translate identity/guidance into one small completed action per day.
Subscription or paywall does not feel worth it	pain	367	60	2.51	The free loop must demonstrate value before asking for deeper paid analysis or personalization.
Show me visible progress so effort feels real	jtbd	308	61	4.06	The avatar/progress object should act as proof of effort, not decoration.
Signup, access, or device friction blocks activation	pain	230	55	2.77	Avoid unnecessary phone-number gates and preserve low-friction first-use flow.
Feel accompanied or accountable	jtbd	168	51	4.47	Companion energy can be useful, but social/community features should not precede the solo daily loop.
Help me calm down or reset quickly	jtbd	162	45	4.54	A two-minute reset is a plausible core unit if it produces relief without feeling clinical or generic.

The strongest product read: Alina should start as one daily ritual that turns personal meaning into one concrete action, then makes the effort visible through progress/avatar feedback. The strongest risk read: subscription gates, broken streak/reward mechanics, vague content, and unsafe overclaiming can destroy trust quickly.

Forum and External Discussion Signals

A first public forum/source map adds 18 qualitative rows. These sources are not representative survey data, but they help triangulate language and objections outside app-store reviews.

Forum signals by market:

- coaching: 5
- astrology_esoterics: 4
- gaming: 4
- mindfulness: 3
- avatar_identity: 2

Forum signals by type:

- subscription_value: 3
- trust_accuracy: 2
- depth_request: 1
- competitor_recommendation: 1
- anti_gamification: 1

- habit_friction: 1
- routine_design: 1
- streak_recovery: 1
- streak_anxiety: 1
- emotional_support: 1
- attachment_behavior: 1
- retention_backlash: 1
- cozy_progression: 1
- retention_mechanics: 1
- daily_loops: 1

Forum quote coding tags:

- streaks_can_create_anxiety: 38
- wants_low_friction_daily_use: 35
- streaks_can_motivate: 30
- rejects_hard_paywall: 22
- wants_emotional_support: 19
- wants_accuracy_explanation: 18
- wants_visible_progression: 18
- safety_boundary_needed: 14
- wants_recovery_or_forgiveness: 6
- rejects_manipulative_gamification: 4

Cross-source read: daily anchors and visible progress are attractive, but users push back against generic guidance, hard paywalls, strict streak punishment, noisy gamification, and spiritual/AI overclaiming.

8. Product Core

Target loop: personal meaning -> one daily action -> short reset -> avatar/identity feedback -> visible progression -> next-day hook.

MVP testable claim: users should understand and complete the full daily loop in under two minutes, then report that the avatar/progress cue makes the action feel more personally meaningful.

9. Risk Register

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
Fragmentation	high	Force one daily flow; avoid separate feature tabs as MVP core.
Avatar novelty churn	high	Tie avatar changes to completed actions and progress, not one-off image generation.
Astrology trust/overclaiming	high	Use soft framing, confidence labels, and avoid deterministic claims.

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
AI hallucination in guidance	high	Constrain advice to low-stakes coaching prompts and clear disclaimers.
Subscription fatigue	medium	Keep daily loop free; monetize depth/personal analysis/advanced progress.
Crowded adjacent markets	medium	Position around integrated transformation loop, not generic astrology/mindfulness/avatar.

10. Go/No-Go Status

Current status: conditional go for continued validation, not yet go for full product build.

Go signals present:

- Adjacent markets have meaningful revenue pools.
- Users are already trained on daily loops, streaks, reflection, and spiritual/personalized guidance.
- Top-100 evidence suggests avatar/identity is common but behavior-tied avatar progression is rare.
- AI-assisted competitor review found many close substitutes but only one direct reference competitor under the strict behavior-tied progression criterion.
- Review language confirms user pull toward daily support, emotional regulation, progress cues, and personal meaning.

Remaining proof required:

- Manual validation of the top-100 candidates.
- Human validation of AI-assisted battlecards and scorecard verdicts.
- Forum evidence and deeper manual clustering of reviews for user pain language and subscription objections.
- Human validation of forum/source quote coding before external-facing use.
- Deeper pricing validation for web/Android products and paywall screenshots where accessible.
- Prototype test of the two-minute daily loop.

11. Source and Claim Layer

Market claims currently normalized: 14.

Claim ID	Market	Value	Period	Confidence	Source
CLM-MKT-0001	mobile gaming	113000000000	2025	High	SRC-MKT-0002
CLM-MKT-0002	mobile gaming	166000000000	2030	High	SRC-MKT-0002
CLM-MKT-0003	meditation and mindfulness apps	1680000000	2026	Medium	SRC-MKT-0003
CLM-MKT-0004	meditation and mindfulness apps	4620000000	2034	Medium	SRC-MKT-0003
CLM-MKT-0005	AI avatars	8400000000	2026	Medium	SRC-MKT-0004
CLM-MKT-0006	AI avatars	93400000000	2035	Medium	SRC-MKT-0004
CLM-MKT-0007	coaching		2026	High	SRC-MKT-0005
CLM-MKT-0008	coaching		2026	High	SRC-MKT-0005
CLM-MKT-0009	astrology apps	16070000000	2026	Low	SRC-MKT-0007

Claim ID	Market	Value	Period	Confidence	Source
CLM-MKT-0010	astrology apps	6240000000	2026	Low	SRC-MKT-0008
CLM-MKT-0011	astrology apps	5690000000	2026	Medium	SRC-MKT-0009
CLM-MKT-0012	coaching platforms	4220000000	2026	Medium	SRC-MKT-0011

12. Appendices / File Map

- docs/research-expansion-master-plan.md
- docs/market/tam-sam-som-model-v1.md
- docs/intersections/whitespace-map-v2.md
- docs/audience/audience-segmentation-v1.md
- docs/audience/review-language-synthesis-v1.md
- docs/audience/review-jtbd-clusters-v1.md
- docs/audience/forum-evidence-synthesis-v1.md
- docs/audience/forum-quote-coding-v1.md
- docs/visuals/chart-index-v1.md
- docs/competitive/top-intersection-review-synthesis-v1.md
- docs/competitive/top100-competitor-review-v1.md
- docs/competitive/top100-competitor-battlecards-v1.md
- docs/competitive/app-store-iap-pricing-v1.md
- docs/product/product-core-evidence-v1.md
- data_processed/tam_sam_som_model.csv
- data_processed/competitor_feature_matrix.csv
- data_processed/audience_signal_matrix.csv
- data_processed/whitespace_signal_matrix.csv
- data_processed/top_intersection_review_prefill.csv
- data_processed/top100_competitor_review_scorecard.csv
- data_processed/app_store_iap_pricing_summary.csv
- data_processed/pricing_retention_matrix.csv
- data_processed/product_core_evidence_matrix.csv
- data_processed/review_signal_matrix.csv
- data_processed/review_jtbd_cluster_summary.csv
- data_processed/review_jtbd_cluster_rows.csv
- data_raw/app_store_top_candidate_reviews.csv
- data_raw/app_store_iap_pricing_raw.csv
- data_raw/forum_evidence_signals.csv
- data_raw/forum_quote_evidence_raw.csv
- data_processed/forum_quote_coding_matrix.csv

- `output/charts/whitespace-bands.svg`
- `output/charts/review-jtbd-clusters.svg`
- `output/charts/sam-base-by-pillar.svg`
- `output/charts/som-scenarios.svg`
- `output/charts/forum-signals-by-market.svg`
- `output/charts/forum-quote-coding-tags.svg`
- `output/charts/top100-competitor-verdicts.svg`
- `output/charts/top100-threat-scores.svg`
- `output/charts/iap-price-bands.svg`

13. Next Work

1. Human-validate the AI-assisted top-100 competitor scorecard and battlecards.
2. Manually validate the highest-signal review clusters and extract exact user language for positioning.
3. Validate pricing beyond App Store web-page IAP rows: Android, websites, paywall screenshots, and trial terms.
4. Build visual charts and render the PDF version.
5. Human-validate retrieval-assisted Reddit/forum/website quote coding.
6. Update go/no-go decision after manual review and user validation.